

NORTHWIND VALUE CASE

Cost to build and operate

- Build (one-time): 3-engineer team, 3 months, \$133,045/yr loaded cost each → **~\$99,783**
- Operate (annual): Tiger Data + Render hosting → **~\$94,460/yr**

What it saves / avoids (12 months)

- **Transfer-cost savings — \$117,660/yr.** Consolidating CaseTrack and DocVault covers ~2 of the 4 systems agents juggle, cutting the transfer rate from 34% to ~17% (~185 avoided transfers/mo × \$53 premium).
- **Document-retrieval time savings — \$757,300/yr.** Unified view removes DocVault's 2–4 min per-call lookup (using 3 min avg). At 57,060 inbound calls/mo × 3 min × 12 = 34,236 agent-hours/yr saved, valued at the given 46,000/yr *fully – loaded rate* (~22.12/hr).
- **Regulator penalty avoidance — up to 2.4M/quarter (9.6M/yr), separately flagged.** Assumes Northwind is currently at risk of, or inside, enhanced monitoring. Not counted in the baseline payback below — treated as upside only.

Expected payback

Even excluding the regulator penalty entirely: \$117,660 + \$757,300 = **\$874,960** in year-one savings, against \$99,783 (build) + \$94,460 (operating) = **\$194,243** in year-one cost. **Net year-one gain: ~\$680,717 — the build pays for itself several times over without relying on the regulator assumption at all.**

Material assumptions

- ~\$99,783 build cost (3-person team, 3 months, cited Ontario engineer benchmark)
- 17% transfer-rate target, based on consolidating ~2 of 4 systems agents currently use
- DocVault savings assume near-zero retrieval time, that every inbound call involves a lookup, and a 2,080-hr working year applied to the given \$46,000/yr agent cost
- Regulator penalty avoidance assumes Northwind is currently at risk of/inside enhanced monitoring
- Operational fees held flat at current hosting pricing for 12 months

If assumptions are wrong

- Transfer reduction lands at only 10% instead of 17%: transfer savings drop proportionally, but DocVault savings alone (~\$757K) still cover build + operating cost several times over
- DocVault benefit is half what's assumed (fewer calls actually need a lookup): that line falls to ~\$378,650/yr — still comfortably covers the full cost of the build on its own
- Regulator penalty was never actually at risk: no impact on the baseline case, since it was never counted in the payback to begin with

